topics/tree/main/chapter14. You can find the contents of any snippet or listing in the .scala file with the same name as the class, object, or trait.

14.1 Alpakka Kafka

Alpakka Kafka is built on Kafka Streams (https://kafka.apache.org/27/javadoc/index.html). The next question might be this: Why not use Kafka Streams instead? You can, but Alpakka allows you to interact with Akka Streams and connect with actors out of the box.

In this chapter, you use the Jackson library—a JSON parser—for serialization, so the data in these examples is stored as JSON in Kafka. To get started, import the following dependencies:

```
val AkkaStreamKafka = "3.0.1"
val AkkaVersion = "2.6.20"
val JacksonVersion = "2.11.4"

libraryDependencies ++= Seq(
  "com.typesafe.akka" %% "akka-stream-kafka" % AkkaStreamKafka,
  "com.typesafe.akka" %% "akka-stream" % AkkaVersion,
  "com.fasterxml.jackson.core" % "jackson-databind" % JacksonVersion     ❶
)
```

❶ Used for serialization

With all these dependencies, let’s look at a simple example of consuming from a topic. The main component of this example is the Kafka consumer source and its settings. Before you can create the consumer, you need to select the settings. These are the deserializers for reading the messages, containing the key and